



Forest colonies

In Bangladesh, the biggest colonies of Indian flying foxes live in the densest forest—where there is a richer supply of fruiting trees and less disturbance from humans.

Himalayas

Handy wing

The wings of all bats are made of thin sheets of skin that extend out from the sides of the body and stretch between the long finger bones of their hands.

Finding fruit

The Indian flying fox lives across India, Pakistan, Bangladesh, and Sri Lanka. These large, fruit-eating bats sleep through the day and wake at dusk to seek out food. They are known to fly up to 90 miles (150 km) in search of the best sources of food—especially fig trees that are heavy with fruit—which they locate with their highly sophisticated senses of sight and smell.

THE WINGSPANS OF INDIAN FLYING FOXES CAN REACH UP TO 6 FT (2 M)

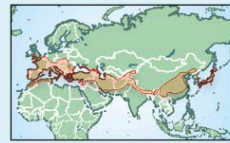
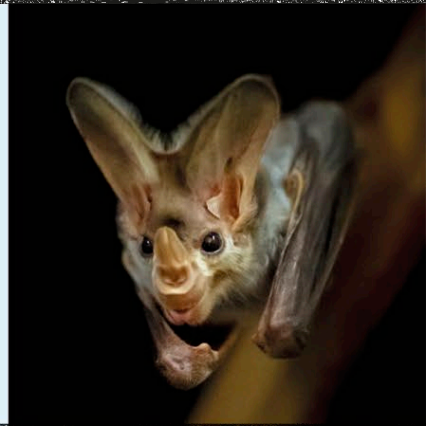


OTHER BATS



Ghost bat

Northern Australia is home to one of the world's biggest predatory bats. The ghost bat hunts mice, lizards, birds, and other bats.



Greater horseshoe bat

Like many other bats, this species tracks insects in flight by homing in on the sound of echoed clicks. This is called echolocation.



New Zealand lesser short-tailed bat

Having evolved on islands originally free of predators, this bat crawls along the ground more than any other species.



Madagascar sucker-footed bat

This bat clings to the smooth surfaces in between folds of palm leaves using tiny suckers on its wrists and ankles.



White-winged vampire bat

This tropical South American bat mainly targets birds—biting and lapping the blood of a sleeping victim.

